

JAMES MITCHELL

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with seven years of hands-on experience building and scaling backend systems. I started my career fixing bugs in legacy codebases and gradually moved into designing distributed systems that handle millions of requests. I've worked across fintech and SaaS companies, mentoring mid-level engineers while keeping my skills sharp through regular code reviews and architecture decisions. I enjoy solving complex performance problems and helping teams ship reliable software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, Bash

Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, DynamoDB

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda)

Tools and Practices: Git, Jenkins, DataDog, New Relic, Grafana, gRPC

System Design: Microservices, Event-driven architecture, Distributed systems, Database optimization

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

FinScale Systems

www.finscale.io

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Architected and implemented a new payment processing pipeline that reduced transaction latency by 40 percent, handling 500K daily transactions across multiple currency pairs with 99.99 percent uptime.

Led the migration of three monolithic services into a microservices architecture using Go and Kubernetes, reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes.

Mentored four junior and mid-level engineers through code reviews, design discussions, and one-on-one sessions, with two promoted to senior roles within 18 months.

Owned the database performance optimization project that decreased query response times by 65 percent through indexing strategies and query refactoring across 15 PostgreSQL instances.

Senior Backend Engineer

DataVault Ltd

www.datavault.co.uk

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

June 2019 - February 2022

Designed and deployed a distributed caching layer using Redis that improved API response times by 50 percent and reduced database load by 35 percent across 12 microservices.

Built a real-time data synchronization service in Python that ingested and processed 2TB of customer data daily, maintaining consistency across five downstream systems.

Established observability standards across the platform by implementing structured logging and custom metrics in Grafana, reducing mean time to resolution for incidents by 58 percent.

Managed the upgrade of the Kubernetes cluster from version 1.18 to 1.26, ensuring zero downtime and coordinating with DevOps and platform teams across two weeks.

Software Engineer

Beacon Technology Solutions

www.beacontech.net

Glasgow, United Kingdom

July 2017 - May 2019

Developed and maintained three core microservices in Java and Go serving 50K daily active users, focusing on reliability, performance, and code maintainability.

Implemented comprehensive integration tests and improved test coverage from 42 percent to 78 percent, catching 30 percent more bugs before production.

Collaborated with product and design teams to translate requirements into technical specifications, delivering four major features on schedule.

Investigated and resolved critical production incidents including a database connection leak that caused cascading failures, implementing preventative monitoring to avoid recurrence.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2017

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate

Certified Kubernetes Administrator